

City Boundaries & Location-Based Display — Implementation Instructions

Status: IMPLEMENT IN BUILD 103 (post-Apple-approval)

The Problem

Cities like Philadelphia and Abington/Willow Grove are 15 minutes apart. A user could live in Abington but work in Philly, or drive through both in the same afternoon. The app needs to handle:

1. What pins appear on the map as users move between cities
 2. How tester experience works across city boundaries
 3. When city-specific content (City Story, Living Legacy) changes
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The Rules

Rule 1: The Map is ALWAYS Location-Based (Option C)

The map shows ALL live pins within a radius of the user's current GPS location, regardless of which "city" those pins are tagged to.

Implementation:

Plain Text

```
GET /businesses?lat={user_lat}&lng={user_lng}&radius={miles}
```

- Default radius: 15-25 miles (adjustable by user zoom level)
- The query returns ALL businesses where:
 - `listing_status` IN ('live_unclaimed', 'live_claimed') (for real users)
 - OR `listing_status` = 'demo' (if `isTester` = true)
 - AND business coordinates are within the radius
- City tags are for ORGANIZATION, not visibility gates
- A user standing at the Abington/Philly border sees pins from BOTH areas
- No hard city boundaries cut off pins mid-map

What this means:

- A Philly user who zooms out sees Abington pins (if Abington is launched)
 - An Abington user who drives into Philly sees Philly pins appear naturally
 - There's no jarring "you left City X" transition — pins just appear and disappear based on proximity
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Rule 2: Home City Determines Personalization (Option A)

The user's HOME CITY (from onboarding Step 1: "Where do you call home?") determines:

- Which City Story they see on their Living Legacy page by default
- Which Kinfolk dialect/voice is used
- Which city's cultural phrases Kinfolk uses
- Their "home" in the app (the city they return to when they tap "Home")

Implementation:

- `users.home_city` is the anchor
- Kinfolk's system prompt uses `home_city` for dialect and cultural context
- The Living Legacy page defaults to `home_city`'s City Story
- BUT — if the user is physically in a DIFFERENT city (GPS shows they're 50+ miles from home), Kinfolk can acknowledge it: "Looks like you're exploring Philadelphia today. Want me to show you what's here?"

What this means:

- An Abington user's Kinfolk speaks to them as an Abington/suburban Philly person
 - If they drive into Center City Philly, the MAP shows Philly pins, but Kinfolk doesn't suddenly change personality
 - They can manually browse other cities' Living Legacy pages anytime
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Rule 3: Tester Status is Account-Level, Not Location-Level

A tester (`isTester = true`) sees demo businesses EVERYWHERE they go — not just in their home city.

Implementation:

- The `isTester` flag is on the user account, not tied to a city
- When fetching businesses, if `isTester = true` , include `listing_status = 'demo'` in results regardless of the user's current location

- Demo businesses have a city tag (so they appear in the right geographic location), but the tester can see ALL demo businesses on the map as they travel

What this means:

- An Abington tester driving into Philly sees: Philly real businesses + Philly demo businesses + Abington demo businesses (if they zoom out enough)
 - Their reviews on REAL businesses (Philly) are real and persist
 - Their reviews on DEMO businesses (anywhere) are test data and get wiped
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Rule 4: City Story / Living Legacy Changes by Location (Soft Transition)

When a user is physically in a different city than their home city, the Living Legacy page should offer BOTH:

Implementation:

- Default: Show home_city's City Story
- If GPS detects user is in a different launched city (>10 miles from home_city center AND within 5 miles of another launched city's center):
 - Show a subtle prompt: "You're in Philadelphia — want to explore its Living Legacy?"
 - Tapping it shows Philadelphia's City Story
 - They can always switch back to their home city
- This is NOT a hard redirect — it's an invitation

What this means:

- An Abington user visiting Philly gets a gentle nudge to explore Philly's history
 - They're never forced out of their home city context
 - The transition feels like discovery, not displacement
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Rule 5: City Launch Controls Pin EXISTENCE, Not Pin VISIBILITY

To be clear about what "city launch" actually does:

- **Before launch:** Businesses tagged to that city have `listing_status = 'staged'` — they don't appear in ANY query (except admin)
- **After launch:** Those businesses become `listing_status = 'live_unclaimed'` — they appear in location-based queries for ANYONE nearby

- **City launch does NOT create a geographic fence** — it just promotes business data from invisible to visible

What this means:

- There's no "you must be in Charlotte to see Charlotte businesses" gate
 - A user in Raleigh who zooms out far enough could see Charlotte pins (if Charlotte is launched and within their radius)
 - City boundaries are metadata, not walls
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Edge Cases

User lives on a city border (Abington/Philly):

- They see pins from both areas on their map (radius-based)
- Their home_city determines Kinfolk's personality
- They can interact with any live business regardless of which city it's tagged to

User travels to an unlaunched city:

- They see no real pins (all staged/invisible)
- If they're a tester, they see demo pins
- Kinfolk can say: "This city hasn't launched yet — but it's coming. Want to be the first to know?"

User's home_city hasn't launched:

- Their map at home shows no real pins (unless nearby launched cities have pins within radius)
- If they're a tester, they see demo pins at home
- Their City Story page shows a "Coming Soon" state (or the historical context from our guides if it's been seeded)

Two businesses with the same name in adjacent cities:

- Both appear on the map as separate pins (already handled by the duplicate detection system — unique key is name + address + city + state)
 - No confusion — they're at different geographic coordinates
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Database Implications

No new tables needed. Existing fields handle this:

Field	Purpose
users.home_city	Personalization anchor, Kinfolk dialect, default Living Legacy
users.is_tester	Account-level flag, controls demo business visibility
businesses.city	Organizational tag, used for city launch trigger
businesses.latitude/longitude	Actual pin placement, used for radius queries
businesses.listing_status	Controls visibility (live vs staged vs demo)
city_launches.status	Tracks which cities are live vs planning

Verification Required

After implementing, please confirm:

1. A user in Abington (home_city = "Abington, PA") opens the map — what do they see? (Expected: demo pins if tester, nothing if not tester, PLUS any live pins from nearby launched cities within radius)
2. That same user drives into Center City Philadelphia — what changes on their map? (Expected: Philly live pins appear as they enter radius, demo pins still visible if tester)
3. Does Kinfolk's voice/dialect change when they cross into Philly? (Expected: NO — home_city determines Kinfolk personality, not current GPS)
4. If they tap Living Legacy while physically in Philly, what do they see? (Expected: their home city's story by default, with a prompt to explore Philly's story)
5. Can a non-tester user in Abington see Philadelphia's live businesses if they zoom out or drive close enough? (Expected: YES — the map is radius-based, not city-gated)